

1. Troubleshooting Log

#	Symptom	Likely cause	Resolution / check
1	Pasted config gives % Invalid input on every line, prompt shows Router(vlan)#	Device was left in VLAN configuration mode	Type exit until the prompt is Router#, confirm ports with show ip interface brief, paste again
2	SSH closes with "closed by foreign host" before any password prompt, even though ping works	RSA key not generated: key generation was interrupted by the rest of a single large paste	Generate the key on its own (crypto key generate rsa general-keys modulus 2048), wait for the prompt, then ip ssh version 2; SSH then worked
3	SSH password prompt shows nothing as you type, then % Password: timeout expired	Passwords are never echoed; the prompt was left idle too long	Type the password without waiting and press Enter
4	deny any log rejected with % Invalid input; show access-lists SSH-MGMT-ONLY showed only the permit line	Packet Tracer does not support log on standard ACL lines	Use deny any on Router0 and Switch0; re-test blocked SSH attempts and confirm the deny counter increases
5	Router0 CLI asks for a Username and Password when I come back to it	Console uses login local with a 5-minute exec-timeout, so an idle session is logged out	Log in with itadmin and its password (type enable and the enable secret if the prompt shows >), then carry on